

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 703

By Hatcher

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend Jennifer Wackerhagen for her contributions to United Way of Blount County and to the State of Tennessee.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should salute those citizens who, through their extraordinary efforts, have distinguished themselves as community leaders of whom we can all be proud; and

WHEREAS, one such noteworthy person is Jennifer Wackerhagen, a highly respected member of her community who has dedicated herself to improving the quality of life for her fellow citizens through twenty-five years of service with United Way of Blount County; and

WHEREAS, Ms. Wackerhagen is a 1993 graduate of Alcoa High School, and she earned her bachelor's degree in communications from the University of Tennessee in 1997; and

WHEREAS, Jennifer Wackerhagen began working at United Way of Blount County in January 2001, during which time she served as Communications and Marketing Director; in 2006, she was promoted to Vice President of Resource Development and became President and Chief Executive Officer in 2013; and

WHEREAS, during her time as Communications and Marketing Director, Ms. Wackerhagen did not even have an office, just a desk tucked in the hallway; however, her passion, grit, genuine care for others, and commitment to serving her community helped her become an indispensable member of the United Way team; and

WHEREAS, Jennifer Wackerhagen quickly rose to the role of Vice President of Resource Development and led annual campaigns, coordinated large-scale fundraising events, and mobilized hundreds of dedicated volunteers to raise funds; over the last twenty-five years, United Way of Blount County has raised more than \$50 million, which has translated to stronger nonprofits, expanded services, and hope for over 750,000 neighbors in need; and

WHEREAS, in 2013, Ms. Wackerhagen was named President and CEO of United Way of Blount County, in which position her caring nature, volunteer spirit, and steadfast work ethic have continued to shine; she has built an organization with incredible community impact and defined what it means to serve with purpose, empathy, and collaboration; and

WHEREAS, for more than two decades, Jennifer Wackerhagen has poured her passion for community service into shaping the mission of United Way of Blount County, strengthening partnerships and fueling real impact for people within the county; and

WHEREAS, since 2012, United Way of Blount County has received consecutive four-star ratings from Charity Navigator, a rank held by only seven percent of charities evaluated by Charity Navigator; this highlights the high performance and transparency of the organization; and

WHEREAS, through her tireless leadership, Jennifer Wackerhagen led United Way of Blount County to be honored by Blount Partnership with the Community Impact Award in 2019; during the pandemic, her proactive leadership and prioritization of health and safety resulted in an increase in monetary and in-kind donations to meet the needs of the community; and

WHEREAS, in 2021, Blount County Mayor Ed Mitchell proclaimed January 29th as Jennifer Wackerhagen Day, in recognition of her then twenty years of service to United Way of Blount County; and

WHEREAS, in addition to serving her community through her work with United Way, Ms. Wackerhagen is an active member of her church, Foothills Church, and she was a member of the 2004 class of Leadership Blount and the East Tennessee Regional Leadership Class of 2008; she received the 20th Anniversary Leadership Blount Alumni Service Award; and

WHEREAS, Jennifer Wackerhagen has served on many boards, including the Leadership Blount Board; Blount Chamber of Commerce Board of Directors; Junior Service League, serving as a past board member and parliamentarian; Blount Memorial Hospital's

Internal Review Board; and Blount County Homelessness Task Force as a stakeholder. She played an integral role in the creation of the Young Leaders Society in 2012 and has helped mentor other nonprofit directors; and

WHEREAS, it is appropriate that the members of this General Assembly acknowledge and applaud Ms. Wackerhagen for her dedication to the State of Tennessee and its citizens; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor and commend Jennifer Wackerhagen for her twenty-five years of service to United Way of Blount County, her community, and the State of Tennessee and extend to her our best wishes for much continued success.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.